

Considerations When Labeling Images

Labeling involves more than just drawing boxes around objects. There are some decisions you'll need to make when labeling images. A few examples are:

- How accurately do you make your bounding boxes?
- Do you use one class or multiple classes when different types of the same object exist?
- How many images do you need to label?
- How should you treat objects that are partially visible?

You'll want to answer these questions before labeling to ensure consistency, especially if you're labeling with a group of people. For example, examine these two images that each contain an electric vehicle parking sign and an electric vehicle charger.



In the left image, the EV charger is labeled even though much of it is not visible. In the right image, the EV sign is not labeled. What would you do in this situation?

There is no single correct answer. Use your domain knowledge and application requirements to help you answer the above questions. For example, you might create a rule that 50% of an object should be visible to be labeled. Or you may decide that if certain distinguishing features are visible, you will label the object. For very large datasets, some inconsistency and mistakes might not matter that much. However, for small datasets, you might find that your labeling choices have an impact on your results.

When starting your own labeling project, think about these issues and aim for consistency. Then, see how your model performs. Does the model find partial objects? This will help inform future images you label or if you should update your labels.

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